📄 How to Generate a GitHub Personal Access Token

1️⃣ What is a GitHub Token?

A **GitHub Personal Access Token (PAT)** is a **secure key** used to authenticate applications when accessing GitHub's APIs.
It works like a password, but is **safer, limited, and revocable**.

2️⃣ Why This Website Needs a Token

This website fetches **open-source issues** directly from **GitHub's GraphQL API**.

GitHub requires authentication to:

- prevent abuse
- control request limits
- protect user data

Without a token:

- the app cannot fetch data
- the loading spinner may run indefinitely

3️⃣ Step-by-Step: How to Generate a GitHub Token

🔹 Step 1: Open GitHub Settings

1. Go to https://github.com
2. Click your **profile picture** (top-right corner)
3. Click **Settings**

📸 *(Insert screenshot: GitHub profile → Settings)*

🔹 Step 2: Open Developer Settings

1. Scroll down the left sidebar
2. Click **Developer settings**

📸 *(Insert screenshot: Developer settings)*

🔹 Step 3: Open Personal Access Tokens

1. Click **Personal access tokens**

2. Click **Tokens (classic)**

📸 *(Insert screenshot: Tokens (classic) page)*

🔹 **Step 4: Generate New Token**

1. Click **Generate new token (classic)**
2. Enter your GitHub password if asked

📸 *(Insert screenshot: Generate new token button)*

🔹 **Step 5: Fill Token Details**

Note (Name): (Example) Find open source project

Expiration:

- Choose **7 days** or **30 days**

Select Scopes (Permissions):

- ✅ public_repo

⚠️ Do NOT select unnecessary permissions.

📸 *(Insert screenshot: public_repo checkbox selected)*

🔹 **Step 6: Generate & Copy Token**

1. Click **Generate token**
2. Copy the generated token immediately

⚠️ You will **not see this token again**.

📸 *(Insert screenshot: token generated screen)*

4️⃣ **Which Permissions to Select**

Select **ONLY**:

- ✅ public_repo

This permission allows the app to read public repositories and issues.

5️⃣ **Important Safety Rules** 🔐

❌ **Do NOT share your token with anyone**
❌ **Do NOT commit your token into code**
❌ **Do NOT upload your token to GitHub**
❌ **Do NOT store token in public files**

If a token is exposed:

- Immediately revoke it from GitHub settings
- Generate a new one

🧭 How to Use the Token on This Website

1. Open the website
2. Paste the token into the **“Enter GitHub token”** input box
3. Select a programming language from the dropdown
4. View the fetched open-source issues

🔐 The token is:

- used only in memory
- never stored
- removed when the page refreshes